

OCTOBER 2019

A month we usually celebrate Dusshera and Gandhi Jayanti, which means trips on long weekends and more excuses to shop online...

NO PIXEL 4

After waiting with bated breath for the launch of the Pixel 4, because we love Pixel cameras and the stock Android experience, with the fastest possible updates to Android... it turned out India wouldn't be getting the Pixel 4 after all! Why? Because the Pixel 4's Soli Radar operated at 60 GHz, which is a frequency banned in India. Then there were rumours that the Pixel would come to India without the Soli Radar (which was one of the most innovative features of the new phone), and then eventually we all resigned to not getting our hands on a Google flagship phone for the first time ever. Oh well!



TARIFF RISE

The bad news started in October, when Airtel CEO announced that current tariffs were unsustainable,

and needed to go up. Mainly because of Jio forcing the tariffs lower, India was enjoying some of the cheapest data rates in the world.

Sadly, nothing good lasts forever, and now we find ourselves embracing for hikes in our bills. Don't forget to check out Boo-man's column this month, he has some choice words on the subject, as usual.



SPACEWALK

NASA conducted an all-female spacewalk from the International Space Station, and many people across the globe watched it live. Of course it lasted 7 hours and 17 minutes, as astronauts Christina Koch and Jessica Meir stepped out into the void to repair a broken battery charging unit. It was nice to see women do yet another thing that men had usually done, and one more barrier to equality fall. Though a few people were questioning the stereotype of women clicking loads of selfies, even when space walking...

IMMORTAL MICE

In October we learnt about scientists who had



slowed aging in mice, by increasing the length of the telomeres. Mice bred with extra long telomeres showed far fewer signs of ageing, and more importantly, seemed to show far fewer signs of age-related diseases. It's still early days, but we might hit on the fountain of youth for mice pretty soon. Human trials and results are too far away to care about right now. Or at least that's what we're told...

Also

- Scientists develop second skin that helps you feel VR content in real life!
- Google kills its VR platform Daydream
- Government plans on merging BSNL and MTNL
- Oral-B AI toothbrush can shame you for not brushing teeth, not brushing them enough, or missing certain areas
- OnePlus 7T McLaren edition goes on sale
- Nvidia GeForce GTX 1660 and 1650 announced

NOVEMBER 2019

The month we work on the December edition that you hold in your hands. It's a killer month for us, while you celebrate Diwali or recuperating from the celebrations, we kill ourselves working! :-)



FITBIT IS GOOGLE'S

This month Google announced that it would acquire Fitbit for \$2.1

billion dollars in an all-cash deal. We expect some interesting things to happen now, as wearables really start to take off with Google's might behind it pushing them to do so...



VAPING BAD!

Apple has banned all vaping apps on its App Store in a move to safeguard the health

of their users. It deleted 181 apps based on health recommendations made to the public by the CDC and the US government. Of course, Apple has removed apps, which obviously are not the same as hardware for vaping. Instead the apps were being used to control vaping hardware, and change

things like the light colour, or could even control the temperature that the vape pens worked at.



WT.SOCIAL

Jimmy Wales, all round good guy and founder of Wikipedia, is someone you would have seen on

Wikipedia once in a while when you were reading an article and saw a plea from him to donate in order to keep Wikipedia running. Well, he's now started a social media company that will focus on accurate news reporting and sharing, and essentially clamping down on fake news. Make sure you get on it right this instant – wt.social is the address you should bookmark.

HALF-LIFE: ALYX

We cannot wait for the next Half-life game, that's coming in March 2020. When we heard the news in November, some of us



who have been waiting for a new HL game since 2007 almost had tears in their eyes! You're going to need VR equipment,

but if history is anything to go by, this is one game that will make the investment absolutely worth it!

Also

- Apple App Store error causes 22 million app ratings to go poof! Apple acknowledged this and said it would restore ratings
- Intel's 10th gen Comet Lake desktop CPUs leaked
- China imposes curfew on online video games for minors
- Facebook testing a meme-making app called Whale
- TikTok developer ByteDance released Jianguo Pro 3 phone powered by Snapdragon 855! 🇨🇳